

SOCOM:**U.S. Navy SEALs Fireteam Bravo**

SOCOM delivers intense online and offline shooter action. With impressive map sizes, and a good control system, this outing on the PSP is a must-have for fans of *SOCOM* and strategic shooters alike.

**Lumines**

For many months, *Lumines* was PSP—the sole reason to own the Sony portable. The title is an ingenious, fiendish, mesmerizing puzzle game which blends falling blocks, with good visuals and perhaps the funkiest, grooviest music on a handheld. Puzzle fans, look no further.

Grand Theft Auto: Liberty City Stories

The same great *GTA* experience, now on the pot or at the bus stop. *Liberty City Stories* offers the same freedom, wanton destruction and mayhem that makes for a *GTA* experience. This game is so good, in fact, that Rockstar is porting it to the PlayStation 2.

X-Men Legends II: Rise Of Apocalypse

A must-own, role-playing game for a fan of the X-Men series. In *Rise of Apocalypse*, you can recruit not only from the band of Xavier X-men, but also from the evil forces of the Brotherhood. Muwahahaha. Cyclops, Wolverine and Juggernaut in the same team, you know you want this!

Wipeout Pure

Perhaps the best racer on the Sony PSP. Not just because it is good to look at but because it has tight controls, great tracks, awesome music and is regularly updated with extra content. If you have a PSP, you need *Wipeout Pure*.

NINTENDO DS

With two screens, one of which is a touch screen, Wi-Fi, and a mic, the DS seemed to be the product of the kind of insanity that only the genius possess. It is now the fastest-selling gaming console in Japan, and has sold more than 13 million units worldwide in just over two years.

Phoenix Wright: Ace Attorney

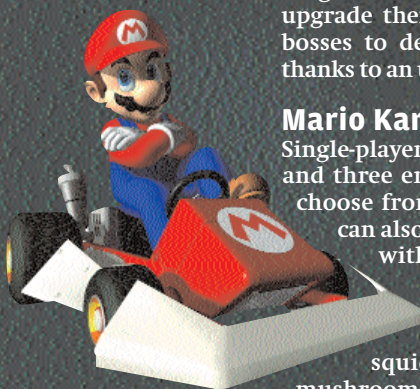
Ace Attorney is part adventure game, part detecting (think *Police Quest* of old), part whacky Japanese characterisation, and all funny and fun! How can you resist a game which encourages you to shout "OBJECTION!" at the DS? You can't, and you shouldn't. Unless you wish to miss out on one of the best gaming experiences of the past year.

**ALSO ON The Nintendo DS:**

- 1 Advance Wars: Dual Strike
- 1 Nintendogs: Dachshund and Friends
- 1 Kirby: Canvas Curse
- 1 Meteos
- 1 Super Mario 64 DS
- 1 Electropunkton
- 1 Resident Evil: Deadly Silence
- 1 Viewtiful Joe: Double Trouble!
- 1 Ultimate Spider-Man
- 1 Mario & Luigi: Partners in Time
- 1 Star Wars Episode III: Revenge of the Sith

Castlevania:**Dawn of Sorrow**

This *Castlevania* experience is arguably the best yet. As a 2D exploration, action and adventure game, nothing beats this title. With a rudimentary role-playing element, the game offers a range of weapons, the ability to customise and upgrade them, a vast castle to explore, huge bosses to defeat, and excellent replay value thanks to an unlockable mode and a level editor.

**Mario Kart DS**

Single-player grand prix races across 32 tracks and three engine classes, eight characters to choose from, each with multiple karts. You can also race against seven of your friends with only a single copy of the game.

Or head online. With zany items such as lightning bolts to shrink your opponents, ink-squirting squids to obscure their vision and mushrooms for boost, the game is a blast offline or on.

Tony Hawk's American Sk8land

A *Tony Hawk's Pro* skating game that goes back to its roots to deliver the goodness which recent titles have floundered with. With a great cell-shaded 3D world, slick presentation, an excellent soundtrack, online multiplayer, and great skate mechanics, the game is just gr8!

Age of Empires: The Age Of Kings

The PC game we all love spawns a turn-based avatar on the Nintendo DS. Although turn-based, the game retains everything that made the PC version great. With five playable factions and more than 20 hours of gameplay, *Age of Empires* will satiate your portable strategy needs.

Sonic Rush

Once upon a time, Sonic was loved. Then Sega did such vile, dreadful things to our favourite hedgehog and broke our heart. We would sulk some more but in *Sonic Rush*, Sega's penance is at hand. This DS outing brings back everything that made Sonic so much fun—speeeeee and crazy looping, jumping levels. The game makes great use of the DS' two screens to maximise the verticals and enhance the sense of speed. If you're a Sonic fan, you must not miss this game! ■

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